SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #25 · WORK AND IDENTITY

“If I lose this job, I lose everything.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

When a household depends on one income, or when a job has also given us our identity, friends, and purpose, the thought of losing it can feel like the end. Past layoffs, an unstable family history, or a workplace that keeps people anxious can add to the fear. Some of the risk is real, and planning is wise, but the belief that we would lose everything can drive anxiety and poor decisions now.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture does not pretend that loss cannot come. But Paul writes that nothing in all creation, neither death nor life, nor the present nor the future, will be able to separate us from the love of God in Christ Jesus. God says do not fear, for I am with you; I will strengthen you and help you. The psalmist says that though a righteous person falls, he will not be overwhelmed, for the Lord is holding his hand. A job can be lost. Our standing with God, our family, and our faith cannot.

> *“For I am convinced that neither death nor life, neither angels nor principalities, neither the present nor the future, nor any powers, neither height nor depth, nor anything else in all creation, will be able to separate us from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord”* (Romans 8:38–39).

Also see

> “Do not fear, for I am with you; do not be afraid, for I am your God. I will strengthen you; I will surely help you; I will uphold you with My right hand of righteousness” (Isaiah 41:10).

> “Though he falls, he will not be overwhelmed, for the LORD is holding his hand” (Psalm 37:24).

> “God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in times of trouble” (Psalm 46:1).

> “But seek first the kingdom of God and His righteousness, and all these things will be added unto you” (Matthew 6:33).

Common self-statements

- If this job ends, my life is over.
- I would lose my home, my friends, and my future.
- I cannot take any risk at work.
- I must say yes to everything to stay safe.
- There is nothing else for me out there.
- I would be nothing.

Common logical errors

- Catastrophizing: Jumping from job loss to total ruin.
- Fortune telling: Predicting disaster before anything has happened.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing that I either keep this job or lose everything.
- Overlooking resources: Forgetting the skills, people, and options I have.

Challenging questions

- What exactly would I lose, and what would I still have?
- What skills, experience, and relationships would I keep?
- Have I faced job uncertainty before, and what happened?
- What is my plan if the worst occurred, even in outline?
- What can I do now to be a little more prepared?
- What can never be taken from me?

Truth summary

> A job loss would be hard, but it would not be the loss of everything. God, my family, my faith, and my abilities would remain. I can plan wisely and prepare without letting fear run my life.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Anxiety/Worry
- Occupation/Job/Work
- Trust
- Refuge/Safety
- Plans

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Unemployment
- Trouble/Hardship

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Even If — MercyMe
Trust in God need not depend on receiving the particular miracle we want.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Whom Shall I Fear — Chris Tomlin
God's presence provides courage without requiring a life free of difficulty.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "If I lose this job, I lose everything"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If I lose this job, I lose everything." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What exactly would I lose?
- ☐ What would I keep?
- ☐ What skills and people do I have?
- ☐ What is one preparation step?
- ☐ What has God done in past uncertainty?
- ☐ What can never be taken from me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Nothing can separate me from God's love.
- ☐ A job loss is a hard event, not the end of my life.
- ☐ I have skills and people that stay with me.
- ☐ God holds my hand when I fall.
- ☐ Planning is wise; panic is not.
- ☐ I can take one preparation step now.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Romans 8:38–39**
  "For I am convinced that neither death nor life, neither angels nor principalities, neither the present nor the future, nor any powers, neither height nor depth, nor anything else in all creation, will be able to separate us from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord."
- ☐ **Isaiah 41:10**
  "Do not fear, for I am with you; do not be afraid, for I am your God. I will strengthen you; I will surely help you; I will uphold you with My right hand of righteousness."
- ☐ **Psalm 37:24**
  "Though he falls, he will not be overwhelmed, for the LORD is holding his hand."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] What I would still have: Each week, write what you would keep if the job ended and one preparation step you took.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Romans 8:38–39 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Nothing can separate me from God's love, so a job loss would not be the loss of everything.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Anxiety/Worry" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] List what cannot be lost. Write faith, family, skills, character, and experience.
- [ ] Make a basic plan. Write a simple what-if plan: who you would call, what you would update, and what you would cut first.
- [ ] Update your resume or contacts. Do one small preparation step this month.
- [ ] Pray Romans 8:38–39. Read it aloud and name your fear to God.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If I lose this job, I lose everything": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A preparation step
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If I lose this job, I lose everything.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You know my fear about losing this job. Hold me, remind me that nothing can separate me from Your love, and help me plan with wisdom instead of panic. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.